



Foldable phones have reached a point in 2025 where they no longer feel like experiments or luxury gadgets for tech enthusiasts. They've become slimmer, lighter and far more practical, paired with software that now fully understands how to shift between a compact phone and a tablet-like canvas. As a result, foldables must now compete directly with the best slab phones in design, performance, cameras and long-term usability. In this year's Digit Zero1 Awards, two models rose above the rest. One offers the most polished foldable experience available today, while the other is a fully decked-out foldable at a more accessible price.

Zero1 Winner: **Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 7**

The Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 7 is our clear winner because it feels like the most complete foldable phone of the year. Samsung has spent several generations refining this form factor, and it shows. The phone is slimmer, lighter and very comfort-

Foldable Phone

The year foldables finally became everyday phones



Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 7
Price: ₹1,74,999



Vivo X Fold 5
Price: ₹1,49,998

able to use for long periods. Both the inner and outer displays impress with top-tier brightness, accurate colours and smooth responsiveness. The hinge feels solid yet moves fluidly, and the overall build feels as premium as you'd expect at this price.

The highlight of the Galaxy Z Fold 7 is its large main display, which boosts productivity, multitasking and media viewing. Samsung's software has also matured, offering better app continuity, cleaner multi-window controls and improved task switching. The camera system is better this year, with the 200-megapixel primary sensor delivering sharp, detailed images and better low-light results. Performance is smooth across everyday use and heavy workloads, and Samsung's seven-year update commitment adds long-term value. While charging speeds still lag behind some rivals and the price remains high, no other foldable matches its overall refinement.

Best Buy & Runner-up: **Vivo X Fold 5**

The Vivo X Fold 5 earns both the Best Buy and Runner-Up awards for delivering exceptional value as a foldable. It feels genuinely premium, with high-quality materials, a lightweight design and a bright, immersive inner display. The outer screen is also well-sized and fully usable for everyday tasks. The triple 50-megapixel camera setup co-engineered with Zeiss is a high-light, especially for colour accuracy and portrait performance.

The X Fold 5 feels smooth and responsive in daily use, with good optimisation across folded and unfolded modes. While it doesn't match Samsung in software polish or long-term updates, it delivers a surprisingly complete foldable experience at a lower price. For anyone wanting a flagship-class foldable without stretching their budget, the Vivo X Fold 5 stands out as the smartest purchase of the year.

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